AYMAN AYAD

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Water Economist and Infrastructure Finance Specialist | Climate-Resilient Infrastructure | PPPs

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Water economist and infrastructure finance specialist with 20+ years of experience structuring, appraising, financing, and overseeing water, wastewater, and social infrastructure investments. Managed a portfolio exceeding €4.0 billion, including €600 million in EU-funded grant financing, and supported mobilisation of more than €1.2 billion in prospective blended finance, guarantees, and co-financing with MDBs, IFIs, and bilateral partners. Combines PhD-level water economics, hydraulic engineering, policy dialogue, and portfolio leadership to move infrastructure investments from concept and prioritisation through due diligence, financing, implementation oversight, and performance improvement.

CORE EXPERTISE

Infrastructure Finance & Investment Planning | Water Economics | PPP Structuring | Blended Finance & Guarantees | Project Appraisal & Due Diligence | Portfolio Management | Climate-Resilient Infrastructure | MDB/IFI Coordination | Policy Dialogue | Public Investment Prioritisation | Technical Assistance Design | Risk Assessment & Mitigation | Water Security & WEFE Nexus | Utility Performance & NRW

SELECTED PORTFOLIO ACHIEVEMENTS

- Managed a €4.0 billion+ water, social infrastructure, and WEFE-related portfolio, including approximately €600 million in EU-funded grant financing across 20+ programmes.
- Initiated and led the Team Europe Initiative for Water and Food Security in Egypt, mobilising €1.2 billion+ in prospective blended finance, guarantees, and co-financing contributions with MDBs, IFIs, and bilateral development partners.
- Directed 21 major infrastructure projects across Egypt, Jordan, and Lebanon, benefiting more than 35 million citizens and supporting EU Southern Neighbourhood policy objectives.
- Structured and advanced PPP and private-sector engagement work exceeding €500 million in pipeline commitments, including investment-support functions with sector ministries.
- Led origination, appraisal, financing-document preparation, due diligence, and implementation oversight for major water, wastewater, irrigation, drainage, and social infrastructure investments.
- Co-chaired the Water Development Partners Group since 2014, convening government counterparts, MDBs, IFIs, UN agencies, and bilateral partners to align policy dialogue, investment priorities, and development-partner coordination.
- Coordinated policy and investment engagement with government counterparts, MDBs, IFIs, EU services, bilateral agencies, utilities, consultants, and private-sector stakeholders.
- Managed multidisciplinary consultant teams and technical assistance assignments supporting project preparation, institutional reform, governance, risk mitigation, and implementation performance.
- Shaped EU-funded water-sector cooperation frameworks covering investment prioritisation, portfolio sequencing, policy alignment, and strategic partnership dialogue.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Sector Manager, Social Infrastructure

11/2018 – Present

European Commission, EU Delegation to Egypt — Cairo, Egypt

Lead EU-funded water, wastewater, social infrastructure, and water-energy-food-ecosystems (WEFE) investment portfolio exceeding €4.0 billion, covering project origination, appraisal, financing preparation, implementation oversight, policy dialogue, and coordination with government counterparts, MDBs, IFIs, bilateral agencies, utilities, consultants, and private-sector stakeholders.

Selected operations: Alexandria West Wastewater Treatment Plant, Gabal Asfar Wastewater Expansion, Fayoum Wastewater Expansion, Kitchener Drain Rehabilitation Programme, National Drainage Programme.

- Managed 20+ infrastructure and technical assistance programmes across the WEFE nexus, maintaining technical, financial, and policy alignment with EU priorities and government investment priorities.
- Expanded the infrastructure investment portfolio by more than 8 times in less than 5 years, diversifying from a water-focused portfolio into 5 social infrastructure sub-sectors: water and wastewater, irrigation and drainage, solid waste, social housing, and agriculture and food security.
- Initiated and led the Team Europe Initiative for Water and Food Security in Egypt, mobilising €1.2 billion+ in prospective blended finance, guarantees, and co-financing contributions through structured engagement with MDBs, IFIs, bilateral development agencies, and EU financing instruments.
- Structured and advanced PPP and private-sector engagement work exceeding €500 million in pipeline commitments, including investment-support functions with sector ministries and transaction-advisory coordination with IFC and AfDB.
- Led project origination, preparation, appraisal, due diligence, financing-document preparation, and implementation monitoring for major water, wastewater, irrigation, drainage, and social infrastructure investments.
- Prepared and supported negotiation of financing agreements and related financing documents for EU-funded investment operations, linking grant resources, partner financing, and government priorities.
- Coordinated financing and co-investment engagement with EBRD, KfW, AFD, IFC, World Bank, AfDB, UKEF, and other partners to structure large-scale infrastructure and climate-resilience operations.
- Conducted project-level due diligence and climate-risk screening, assessing viability, development-finance eligibility, adaptation benefits, GHG emissions reduction potential, and alignment with EU climate and sustainability priorities.
- Designed and managed technical assistance assignments for government entities, including terms of reference, consultant mobilisation, institutional reform support, investment planning, and portfolio performance tools.
- Monitored implementation performance through field visits, contractor follow-up, schedule reviews, risk assessment, and direct advice to project promoters to address bottlenecks and strengthen delivery.

Programme Manager, Water and Utilities

05/2013 – 11/2018

European Commission, EU Delegation to Egypt — Cairo, Egypt

Led programming, identification, appraisal, financing preparation, and implementation oversight for EU-funded water and utilities programmes in Egypt, working with government counterparts, utilities, development partners, consultants, and sector stakeholders.

- Prepared EU financing decisions and supported negotiation of financing agreements for 10 water-sector investment programmes with an estimated total investment volume of €2.0 billion, including approximately €350 million in EU grant financing.

- Prepared and managed 7 technical assistance programmes in Egypt's water sector with a combined budget of approximately €35 million, supporting project preparation, institutional capacity, sector reform, and implementation performance.
- Advanced delivery of the Improved Water and Wastewater Services Programme, Phase I (IWSP-I), a €295 million programme improving water and wastewater services for approximately 4 million inhabitants in the Delta region.
- Coordinated investment and implementation engagement with IFIs and bilateral development partners, including KfW, AFD, the World Bank, and EBRD, strengthening continuity between EU grant resources, partner lending, and government water-sector priorities.
- Developed sector investment frameworks, performance indicators, and pipeline inputs for irrigation, water resources, wastewater, and utilities, linking policy priorities with bankable project preparation and financing decisions.
- Coordinated consultant supervision, procurement inputs, climate-risk screening, and performance monitoring across water-sector programmes, strengthening project readiness, compliance, and delivery quality.

EARLIER TECHNICAL AND ADVISORY EXPERIENCE

Full-Time Utility Employment

Engineer / Senior GIS and Hydraulic Analysis Expert
09/2005 – 04/2013

Alexandria Water Company — Alexandria, Egypt

Led hydraulic analysis, GIS-based planning, and infrastructure performance support for Alexandria's water utility, covering transmission systems, distribution networks, water treatment assets, and strategic investment planning.

- Planned and monitored maintenance priorities for approximately 400 km of transmission pipelines and 15,000 valves annually, supporting reliability, operational continuity, and asset-management discipline.
- Supported strategic upgrades to West Alexandria's water infrastructure serving more than 1.5 million residents, combining hydraulic modelling, GIS analysis, field data, and engineering judgement to improve supply reliability.
- Contributed to water master-plan updates, NRW analysis, technical specifications, and investment proposals for water and stormwater infrastructure.

Concurrent Consulting & Advisory Assignments

Water Resources Planning Consultant
10/2010 – 12/2012

Mott MacDonald — Cairo, Egypt

- Prepared a strategic water resources roadmap for Northern Egypt and supported a 5-year water resources investment plan exceeding USD 800 million.
- Developed IWRM strategy inputs, decision-support tools, KPIs, feasibility assessments, ESIA-related risk analysis, and mitigation plans to strengthen investment prioritisation and climate-sensitive planning.
- Designed capacity-building materials and stakeholder engagement inputs for governorate resource units, civil-society actors, and public-sector teams working on water resources and climate policy.

Water Resources Engineer
05/2009 – 10/2010

Egyptian Consulting Office — Alexandria, Egypt

- Supported water infrastructure planning, design review, technical proposal assessment, and investment alignment across assignments in Egypt, Libya, Ethiopia, and Saudi Arabia.

- Identified network optimisation opportunities and cost-efficiency measures, including strategies reported to reduce pipe-network investment costs by approximately 20%.

Water Resources Engineer
07/2009 – 08/2010

Center for Environment and Development for the Arab Region and Europe (CEDARE) Alexandria, Egypt

- Led technical inputs for Alexandria's Integrated Urban Water Management plan to 2037, including investment prioritisation, institutional coordination, stakeholder engagement, and monitoring arrangements.
- Initiated a €7 million institutional-support component and prepared technical reports on desalination viability, climate-change impacts, flooding mitigation, and decision-support tools for urban water management.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Irrigation Engineering and Hydraulics 2021
Ain Shams University, Cairo, Egypt
Dissertation: Economic-Based Investment Planning for Integrated Water Resources Management. Graduated cum laude.

M.Sc., Irrigation Engineering and Hydraulics 2010
Alexandria University, Alexandria, Egypt
Dissertation: Economic Planning of Water Networks. Graduated cum laude.

Diploma, Managing Transboundary Environmental Resources 2012
Dickinson College, Pennsylvania, USA
Focus: Integrated Water Resources Management.

Diploma of Higher Education, Geographic Information Systems 2007
Arab Academy for Science and Technology, Alexandria, Egypt

B.Sc., Civil Engineering 2005
Alexandria University, Alexandria, Egypt

CERTIFICATIONS

PMP Certified | Chartered Civil Engineer, Egyptian Engineers Syndicate | Certified Engineering Consultant in Water and Wastewater Networks | GIS Certified

ACADEMIC, TEACHING AND KNOWLEDGE CONTRIBUTIONS

Visiting Associate Professor, Faculty of Engineering, Ain Shams University, contributing to the MSc course in Integrated Water Resources Management since 2025, with focus on water governance, climate resilience, WEFE nexus, project appraisal, and infrastructure financing.

Guest lecturer and speaker on water resources, infrastructure investment, SDGs, development-partner coordination, NRW, and GIS applications in the water sector, including selected engagements at PPP MENA Conference, FAO Land & Water Days, EU African Water Investment Conference, Egypt Infrastructure and Water Expo, and Cairo Food Summit.

TRAINING

Training Delivered

Water demand management, monitoring and evaluation systems, GIS applications in the water sector, and development-partner coordination, including assignments with the Institute for Sustainable Futures, IWMI, SWITCH, EU-funded programmes, Alexandria University, GUC, and regional training platforms.

Training Attended

European Commission training in external action and development cooperation, including EU blending strategies, budget support, monitoring and evaluation, stakeholder analysis, political economy, fragility and conflict sensitivity, environmental safeguards, and climate-related programming.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Ayad, A., Khalifa, A., El Fawy, M., & Moawad, A. (2021). “An integrated approach for non-revenue water reduction in water distribution networks based on field activities, optimisation, and GIS applications.” Ain Shams Engineering Journal, 12(4), 3509–3520.
- Ayad, A., Khalifa, A., & El Fawy, M. (2021). “Holistic assessment of the Egyptian National Land Reclamation Project from the view of IWRM.” Journal of Environmental Treatment Techniques, 9(4), 776–787.
- Ayad, A., Khalifa, A., & El Fawy, M. (2021). “An assessment of the integrated water resources management in Egypt.” Journal of Environmental Treatment Techniques, 9(4), 751–768.
- Ayad, A., Awad, H., & Yassin, A. (2018). “Integrated approach for the optimal design of pipeline networks.” Alexandria Engineering Journal, 57(1), 87–96.
- Ayad, A. (2013). Economical Design of Pipeline Networks. Saarbrücken: LAP LAMBERT Academic Publishing.

Annex 1: Full publication list.

LANGUAGES

Language	Level	CEFR
Arabic	Native	—
English	Proficient	C2
French	Elementary	A2

REFERENCES

Professional references available upon request.